

# Employee Well-being and Workplace Attendance: A Longitudinal Study

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## Abstract

We examine whether employee well-being predicts attendance. Employees in a large financial services firm ( $N = 412$ ) completed the Satisfaction with Life Scale (SWLS) at baseline and we tracked their attendance over the next 12 months.

## 1 Method

**Life satisfaction was measured using the 5-item Satisfaction with Life Scale (SWLS; Diener et al., 1985), a 7-point Likert instrument assessing global life satisfaction. No other well-being dimensions were measured.** Attendance was captured from HR records as the percentage of scheduled workdays attended over the 12-month follow-up.

## 2 Results

Baseline SWLS scores positively predicted 12-month attendance ( $B = 0.34$ ,  $p < .01$ ,  $R^2 = 0.18$ ). The effect survived controls for age, gender, job level, and baseline attendance.

## 3 Discussion

These findings demonstrate that **employee well-being** drives attendance. Firms seeking to improve attendance should invest in **well-being programs**: wellness initiatives, mental-health support, and work-life balance interventions can be expected to translate into measurable attendance gains. Our results contribute to the broader literature on **wellbeing at work**, supporting the view that holistic well-being — emotional, psychological, and social — is causally prior to work outcomes.